

Quit Smoking

Social Group Feature – Research Interview Guide

Purpose of This Interview

This interview is designed to uncover how social interactions impact a person's attempt to quit smoking — both positively and negatively.

We are not trying to validate an idea or prove that a group feature is useful.

We are trying to understand:

- When social environments help vs hurt quitting
- What real support looks like in behavior (not just words)
- What kinds of interactions create pressure, relapse, or motivation
- What a good vs bad group experience actually feels like

Key Principles for the Interviewer

- Do not lead the participant toward any idea
- Do not mention features like "groups", "chat", or "app ideas" upfront
- Focus on real past experiences, not opinions or hypotheticals (until later)
- Your goal is to learn, not confirm
- If answers feel vague, go deeper — don't move on too quickly

Context to Share with Participant

"I'm working on something related to helping people quit smoking. I'm trying to understand what it's actually like to quit when people around you smoke — not the health side of it, just the social side. I have a few questions, there are no right or wrong answers, and I'm not evaluating you in any way. This will take about 15 minutes."

Interview Structure (15–20 mins)

1. Grounding in Real Experience |

Goal

Anchor the conversation in a real, specific attempt.

Questions

- Walk me through the last time you tried to quit or cut down. What was going on in your life then?
- Who around you knew about it?
- What did they actually do or say?

2. Social Trigger Moments

Goal

Understand emotional and social pressure.

Questions

- Tell me about a specific moment when others were smoking and you were trying not to. What happened?
- What were you feeling in that moment?
- Did you feel left out, pressured, annoyed, or something else?
- What would have made that situation easier?

3. Helpful vs Harmful Support

Goal

Identify what actually works vs doesn't.

Questions

- Did anyone make it easier for you to quit? What exactly did they do?
- Did anyone make it harder — even unintentionally? What happened?
- When someone says "I'm here for you," what does that actually look like in behavior?

4. Group Dynamic Exploration

Goal

Explore realistic group interaction patterns.

Questions

- If you and a few friends were trying to quit at the same time, what would that look like day-to-day?
- Would you want frequent interaction or only during tough moments?
- Would seeing others fail affect you? How?

5. Bad Day Scenario

Goal

Design for critical moments.

Questions

- Imagine you had a really bad day and felt like smoking again. What would you want from others in that moment?
- What would annoy you or push you away instead?

6. Anti-Patterns & Reality Check

Goal

Identify risks and false positives.

Questions

- What kind of group or social setup would you avoid completely?
- If something like this existed, do you think you'd actually use it consistently? Why or why not?

Interview Psychology & Best Practices

What to Look For

- **Specific stories > general opinions**
- Emotional cues (hesitation, frustration, excitement)
- Contradictions between what they say vs what they did
- Moments of discomfort — often where truth lies

What to Avoid

- Leading questions ("Would this help you?")
- Pitching your idea during the interview
- Filling silence too quickly
- Accepting surface-level answers

What to Do

Ask follow-ups like:

- "Can you tell me more about that?"
 - "What happened right after?"
 - "How did that make you feel exactly?"
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- Let silence work — people often reveal more if you wait
 - Stay neutral — no judgment, no validation bias

Mindset to Maintain

- You are here to discover reality, not design in real-time
- Bad feedback is more valuable than good feedback
- If people reject the idea, that's useful data — not failure

Final Note

Strong interviews don't feel like surveys — they feel like conversations.

Your job is to gently guide, dig deeper, and uncover what people actually experience, not what they think sounds right.